

PROTOCOL definitions MAY appear at the global naming scope, or within a namespace definition. However, **PROTOCOL** definitions SHALL NOT be nested within other **PROTOCOL** definitions at any depth.

Every **PROTOCOL** definition SHALL include an **id** qualifier giving the **id** of the protocol, that uniquely identifies the protocol among all other protocols. The **id** given in a **PROTOCOL** definition SHALL be unique relative to all other **PROTOCOL** definitions in a schema. However, it is legal to have multiple **PROTOCOL** definitions with the same protocol id, provided that they also have the same name and appear within the same naming scope. The effect of this is as if there were only a single **PROTOCOL** definition containing a union of the enclosed definitions. This makes it possible to break up a **PROTOCOL** definition across multiple schema files.

PROTOCOL Definition Example

```
namespace some.names {  
  
    my-protocol => PROTOCOL [ VENDOR:0x0008 ]  
    {  
        laser-transducer-metadata [1] => STRUCTURE  
        {  
            serial-num [1] : OCTET STRING,  
            ...  
        },  
  
        optics-array [2] => ARRAY OF optical-specification  
    }  
  
}
```

B.2.5. VENDOR Definition (vendor-def)

VENDOR Definition Syntax

```
name => VENDOR [ qualifier ]  
  
qualifier:  
    id
```

VENDOR associates a name with a Vendor ID. **VENDOR** definition SHALL include an **id** qualifier giving the **id** of the vendor.

In a TLV Schema that includes a **VENDOR** definition, the vendor name MAY be used elsewhere in the schema as a stand-in for the associated **Vendor ID**. One such place where a vendor name may appear is within the id qualifier of a **PROTOCOL** definition.

VENDOR definitions MAY only appear at the global name scope, implying they SHALL NOT be placed within the body of a **namespace** or **PROTOCOL** definition.